

Managing Windows Defender

Antimalware Service Executable
High Disk or CPU Usage



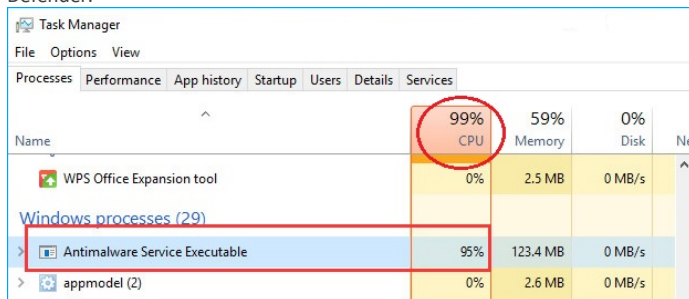
Managing Windows Defender: Antimalware Service Executable High CPU/Disk Usage

Windows 10 includes Windows Defender, Microsoft's built-in antivirus. The Antimalware Service Executable process is Windows Defender's background process. This program is also known as MsMpEng.exe and is part of the Windows operating system.

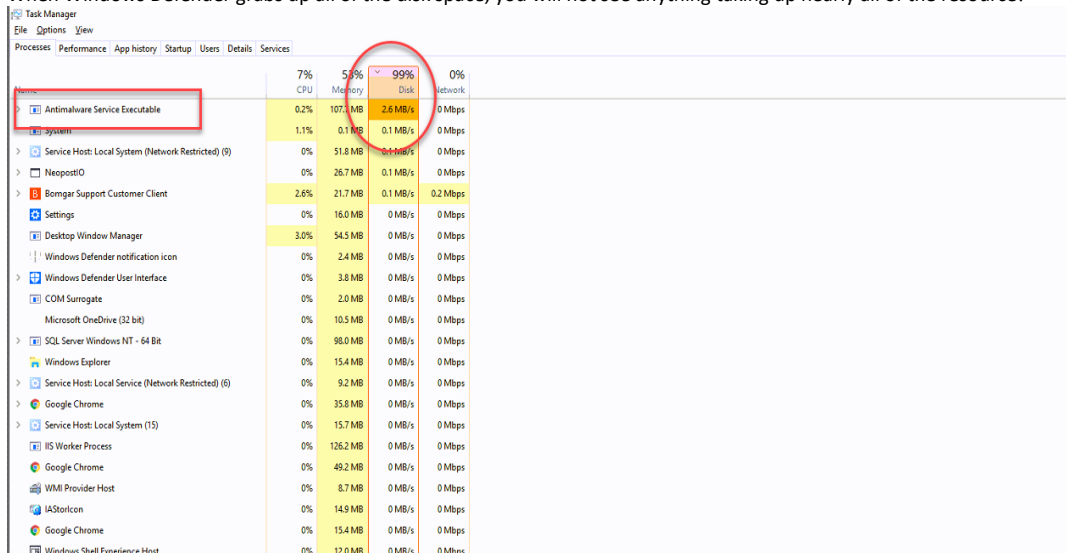
One core difference between Windows Defender in Windows 8 and 10 is that you cannot turn off Windows Defender completely anymore using the preferences provided in the application.

It is responsible for checking files for malware when you access them, performing background system scans to check for dangerous software, installing antivirus definition updates, and anything else a security application like Windows Defender needs to do. That is why it is very likely to take up huge chunks of disk, memory, RAM and even network bandwidth, draining computer resources, especially after getting a Windows 10 update.

When Defender grabs all of the CPU resource, you typically can see the high percentage of CPU assigned to Antimalware Service Executable, which is Windows Defender.



When Windows Defender grabs up all of the disk space, you will not see anything taking up nearly all of the resource!



How Can I Fix Antimalware Service Executable High CPU/Disk Usage

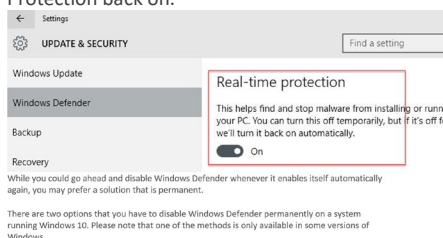
If the Antimalware Service Executable process takes up high CPU on your Windows 10, do not worry. We have easy solutions for you to deal with it.

Solution 1 & 2 below should be executed on every Quadient supplied AIMS, IMOS, and FlexMail PC.

Solution 1 - Change Windows Defender Scheduling Options

Changing Windows Defender's schedule is an effective way because the error is mainly caused by real-time protection feature.

Note: You can turn off Real-time protection from within the application settings. However this is only temporary. The program will automatically turn Real-time Protection back on.

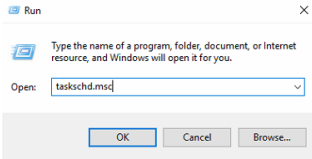


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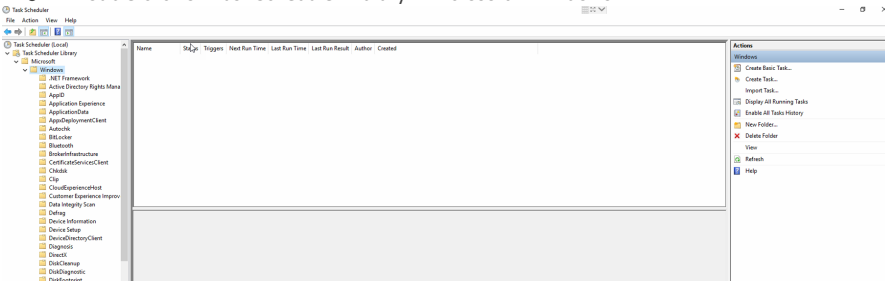
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Follow the details below and fix 'antimalware service executable high disk usage' issue.

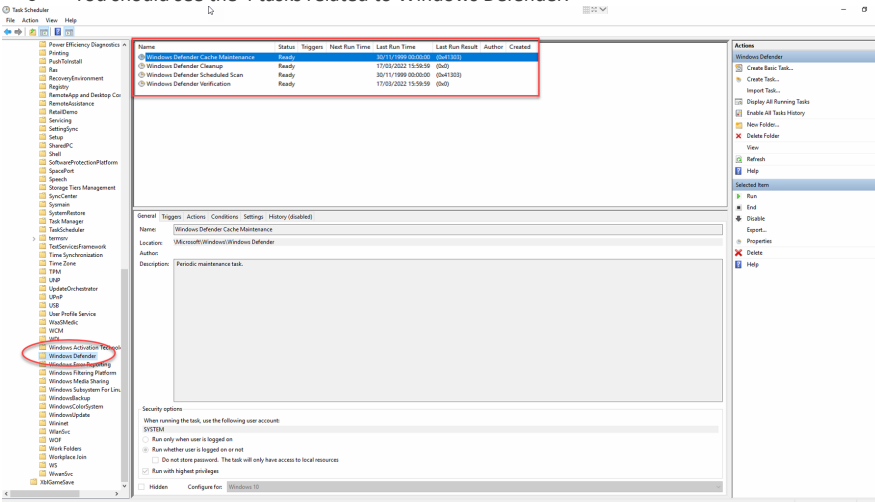
- Press the Windows logo key + R at the same time to invoke the Run box.
- Type taskschd.msc and press Enter.



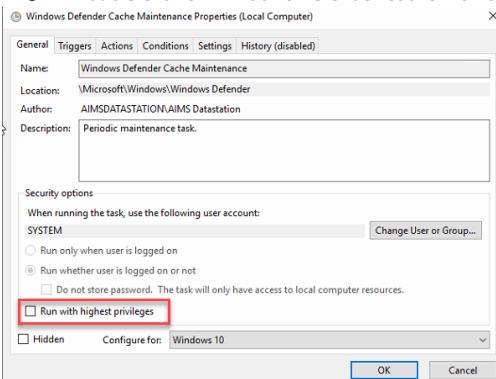
- Double-click on Task Scheduler Library > Microsoft > Windows.



- Double-click Windows Defender in Windows.
- You should see the 4 tasks related to Windows Defender.



- Double Click on Windows Defender Cache Maintenance.

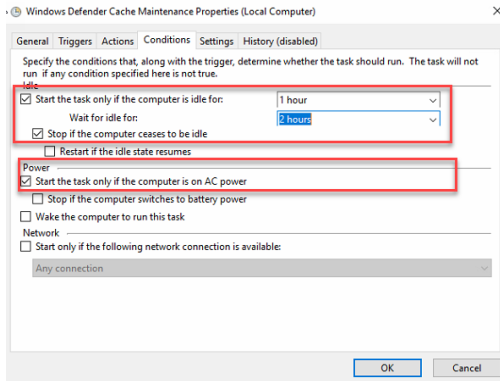


- Uncheck Run with highest privileges.
- Click on the Conditions Tab.
 - Select "Start the task only if the computer is idle for: 1 Hour (set to 1 Hour)
 - Select "Stop if the computer ceases to be idle: 2 Hours (set to 2 Hours)
 - Select "Start the task only if the computer is on AC Power."



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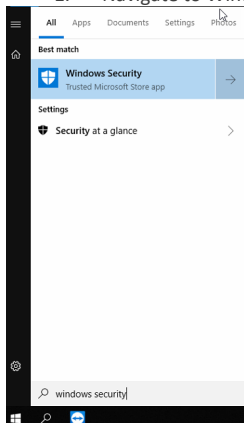
Perform the same steps for:

- Windows Defender Cleanup
- Windows Defender Scheduled Scan
- Windows Defender Verification

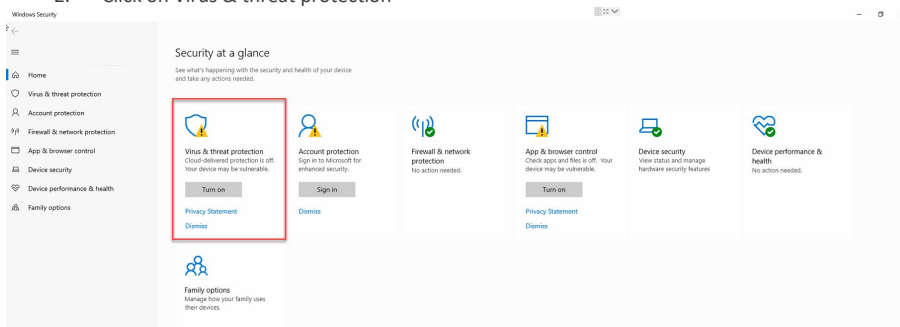
Name	Status	Triggers	Next Run Time	Last Run Time	Last Run Result	Author	Created
Windows Defender Cache Maintenance	Ready			30/11/1999 00:00:00	(0x41303)		
Windows Defender Cleanup	Ready			17/03/2022 15:59:59	(0x0)		
Windows Defender Scheduled Scan	Ready			30/11/1999 00:00:00	(0x41303)		
Windows Defender Verification	Ready			17/03/2022 15:59:59	(0x0)		

Solution 2 – Set Folder & Process Exclusions

1. Navigate to Windows Security.



2. Click on Virus & threat protection

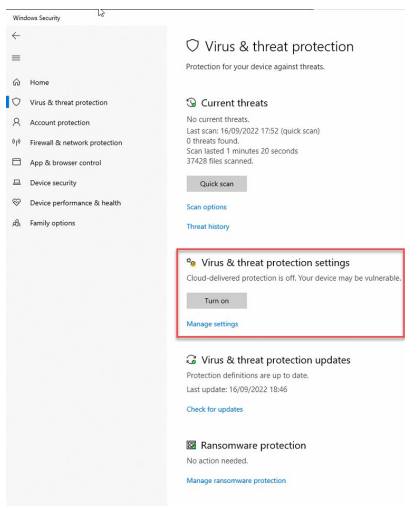


3. Find "Virus & threat protection settings" and select "Manage Settings."



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4. Find “Exclusions” and select “Add or remove exclusions.”

Exclusions

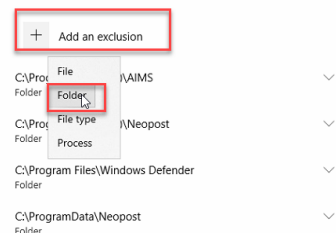
Windows Defender Antivirus won't scan items that you've excluded. Excluded items could contain threats that make your device vulnerable.

[Add or remove exclusions](#)

5. Click the + sign “Add an exclusion,” and select “Folder.”

Exclusions

Add or remove items that you want to exclude from Windows Defender Antivirus scans.



6. Add the following Folder Exclusions:

- a. AIMS PC
 - i. C:\Program Files (x86)\AIMS
 - ii. C:\Program Files (x86)\Windows Defender
 - iii. C:\Program Files\Windows Defender
- b. IMOS PC with AIMS On-Board
 - i. C:\Program Files (x86)\AIMS
 - ii. C:\Program Files (x86)\Windows Defender
 - iii. C:\Program Files\Windows Defender
 - iv. C:\Program Files (x86)\Neopost
 - v. C:\ProgramData\Neopost
- c. FlexMail PC
 - i. C:\Program Files (x86)\Windows Defender
 - ii. C:\Program Files\Windows Defender
 - iii. C:\Program Files\Flex Systems

7. Add the following Process Exclusions:

- a. AIMS PC and IMOS PC with AIMS On-Board
 - i. MsMpEng.exe
 - ii. neopostIO.exe
 - iii. neopostenterprise.exe
- b. FlexMail PC
 - i. MsMpEng.exe



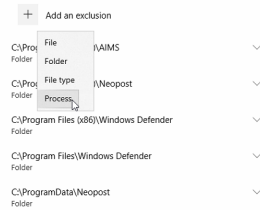
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Exclusions

Add or remove items that you want to exclude from Windows Defender Antivirus scans.



Add an exclusion

Enter process name

neopostio.exe

[Learn more](#)

Add Cancel

Add an exclusion

Enter process name

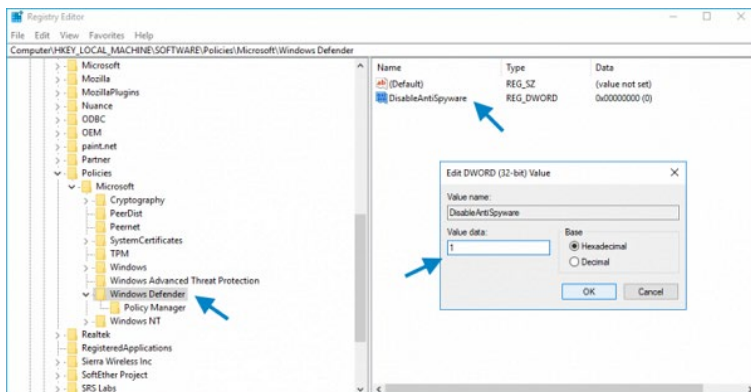
neopostenterprise.exe

[Learn more](#)

Add Cancel

Solution 3 - Disable Windows Defender

- Perform this step as a worst case scenario if you are unable to control Windows Defender.
- Press Windows Key + R to open the Run Dialog Box.
- In the Run Dialog Box, type regedit and click OK to open the Registry Editor.
- In the navigation pane on the left, double-click the folders to navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows Defender.
- If you find a registry entry named DisableAntiSpyware, double-click it and set its value data to 1.



Note: If you do not see a registry entry named DisableAntiSpyware, right-click in the main Registry Editor Pane and select New > DWORD (32 bit) Value. Name this new registry entry DisableAntiSpyware. Double click it and set its value data to 1.

Alternative Methods

Install another Anti-Virus Solution

When another Anti-Virus solution is installed, Windows Defender will turn itself off.

Note: This "other AV must be recognized by the operating system."

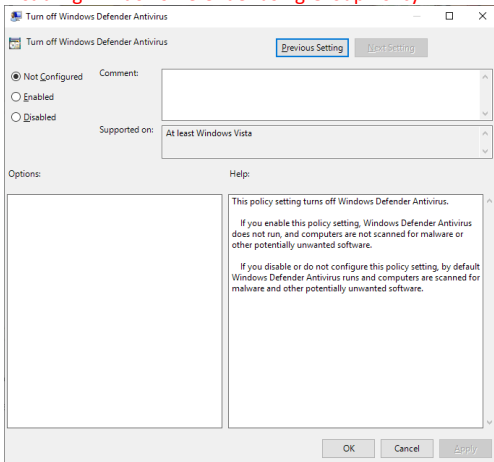


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Disabling Windows Defender using Group Policy



The Group Policy Editor is only part of Windows 10 Pro and Enterprise. To turn off Windows Defender using it do the following:

1. Tap on the Windows-key to open the Start Menu.
2. Type gpedit.msc and hit enter.
3. Confirm the UAC prompt to continue.
4. You find the setting by following this path: Local Computer Policy > Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Defender Antivirus.
5. There you find the policy "Turn off Windows Defender Antivirus".
6. Double-click on the policy.
7. Set the state of the policy to enabled in the window that opens, and click ok to save the change.

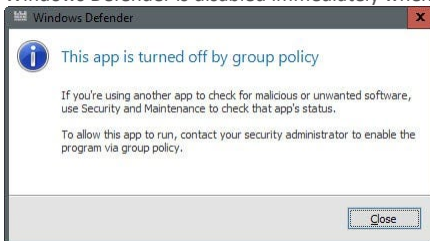
The policy reads:

This policy setting turns off Windows Defender.

If you enable this policy setting, Windows Defender does not run, and computers are not scanned for malware or other potentially unwanted software.

If you disable or do not configure this policy setting, by default Windows Defender runs and computers are scanned for malware and other potentially unwanted software.

Windows Defender is disabled immediately when you make the change. Any attempt to run the program afterwards results in the following error message.



To restore the functionality of the app, set the policy state to disabled or not configured.

